



The first cruise of the *Sumter*

This 19th-century lithograph shows the commerce raider CSS *Sumter* eluding USS *Brooklyn* to break through the Federal blockade at the mouth of the Mississippi River, on June 30, 1861.

The *Florida*

The first of the legends was built in Liverpool, England, as the *Oreto*, but off a deserted cay in the Bahamas the ship took on arms and, in August 1862, became CSS *Florida*. During the next 14 months, cruising mostly in the West Indies, *Florida* took 38 prizes. Her career ended one October night in 1864 when, anchored in the neutral port of Bahia, Brazil, she was commandeered by daring Union sailors—while most of her crew was ashore—and sailed to the United States.